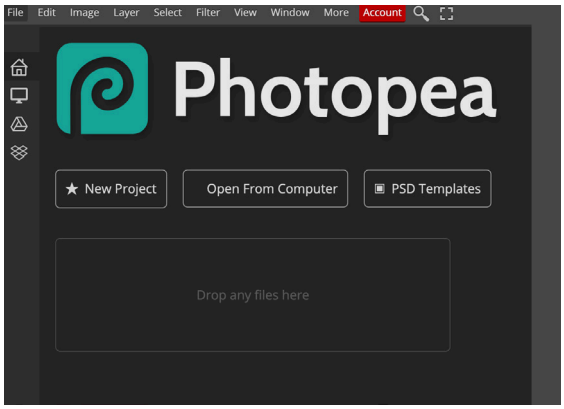
Creating and Editing Raster Images

Part of creating great visual web design and UX projects is being able to create and edit graphics. Professional graphic designers use many different programs to do this. Popular programs include: Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe XD, GIMP and Inkscape. In this lab we will learn how to create and edit raster images using a free online application PhotoPea.

PhotoPea

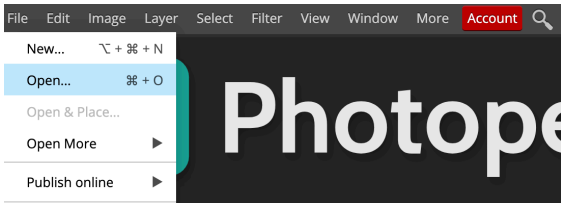


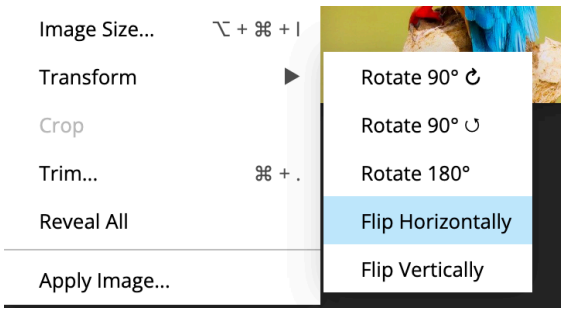
PhotoPea is an free online photo editing program. Since it is browser based it should work on all major desktop / laptop computer regardless of operating system. PhotoPea has the ability to edit raster / pixel based images and graphics. The program is similar to programs like *Adobe Photoshop* and *GIMP*.

To begin using the program use the hyperlink below:

https://www.photopea.com/

Edit a Photo

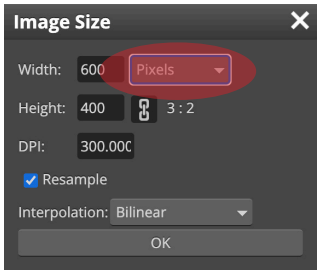




We are going to begin by loading an image in PhotoPea and editing it. Go to the *File* menu at the top left and choose *Open*, this will open a dialogue box. Load *bird.psd* into PhotoPea from the lab files.

Let's begin by flipping the image so that the bird faces to the right, instead of the left. To do this go to *Image > Transform > Flip Horizontally* and you'll see the image flip.

Next, let's look at the dimensions of our image. To do this we are going to go to *Image > Image Size* in the menu. This option will open a dialogue box that shows the dimensions of the file. If not already, make sure the dimensions are measured in pixels.

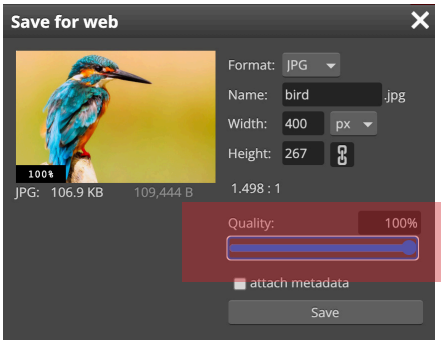


Good design practices would state it is best **not** to make raster image larger than normal, as it will cause image distortion; however it's perfectly fine to make the image smaller than the default. Let's change the dimensions from 1200px x 800px to 600px x 400px. To do this click in the *width* and *height* boxes to type in the new values. To save the changes click the *Ok* button at the bottom of the dialogue box.

Save the changes you've done to the file by going to *File > Save*.

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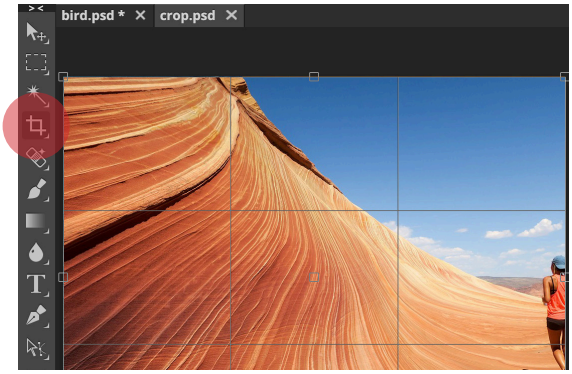
Export to Alternative File Formats



The default file format of PhotoPea is the *.psd* or Photoshop Document. It is typically recommended to use the *.psd* format when working in applications like PhotoPea or Adobe Photoshop to save complex documents. The problem is we can not use the PSD format for web design as browsers do **NOT** accept it. Instead we'll need to convert our PSD format to another image format.

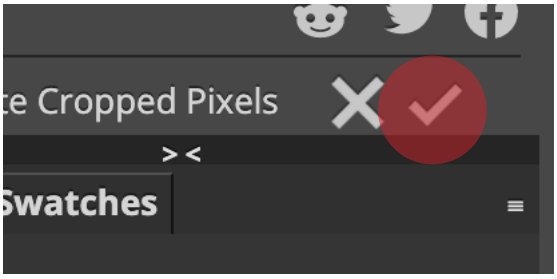
Click the *File* button and to *Export As > JPG*, this will convert the document to a JPG file format. In the save menu make sure *Quality* is set to 100% for maximum image quality. Hit *Ok* and your file will be downloaded to your computer as *bird.jp*g, rename the image *lastname-bird.jpg* and store it for submission.

Crop an Image



Now that have the basics on PhotoPea down, let's learn how to crop an image. Many times we may want to crop an unnecessary or bad part from our main image.

Open *crop.psd* into PhotoPea. When you open the image you'll see a beautiful desert landscape, but part of a hiker is one right hand side. This is a bit distracting, so let's crop the hiker from our image.



Choose the *crop tool* from the toolbar on the left hand side of the program it looks like two L's overlapping one another. This will put you into crop mode. Use the white squares on the edges of the rectangle to set the prime area. The area that outside of the gray rectangle will be cropped. When you are done setting your prime area hit the *Enter / Return* key on your keyboard or use the √ in the menu toolbar at the top right to finalize the crop.

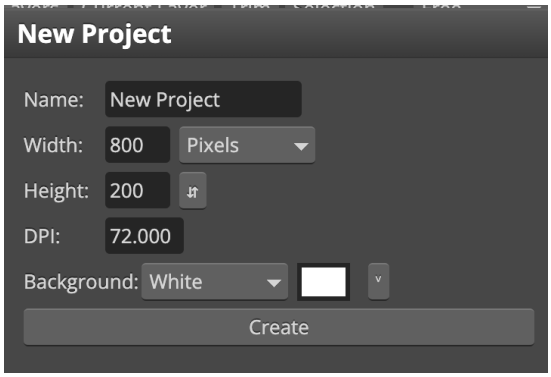


If you are unhappy with the crop go to *Edit > Undo* to undo your last action in the program and repeat the crop action again. Export your file as JPG to your computer and label it *lastname-crop.jpg*. Store it for your submission.

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Create a New Document

So PhotoPea can open and make basic changes to an existing image, but what if we want to make our own more sophisticated document? To do this we will create a document from scratch.



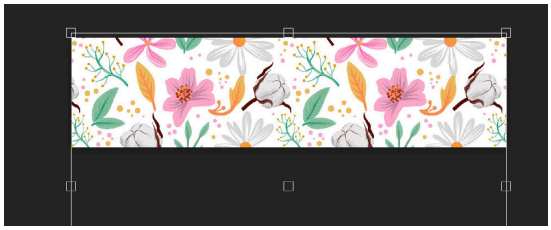
Go to *File > New* to create a new document from scratch. When you do this PhotoPea will ask you to set up dimensions for the document in pixels. For this lab set the *Width* and *Height* dimensions to 800x x 200px. Set *DPI* to 72 and set the *Background* to white. When you are done click the *Create* button at the bottom. This will create an empty canvas for us.

Add Image

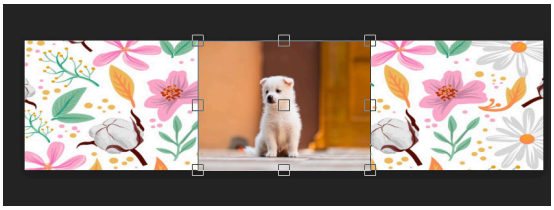
Now that we have a canvas, let's begin by adding images into our document.



Go to *File > Open and Place* and upload *floral.jpg* into your document. You will see that a floral design has now been added. When you place an imported image you will need to resize and place the image within the canvas. You can use the free transform options to resize and place the floral design within the canvas. Hit *return* or use the √ in the menu toolbar at the top right to finalize the resizing.



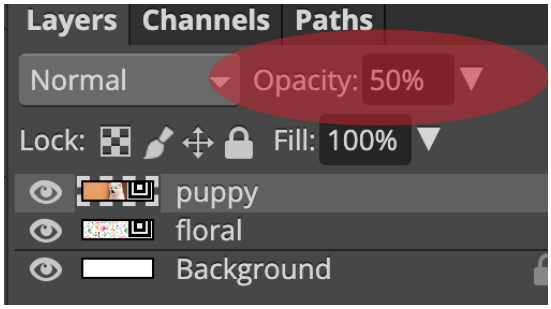
Now that we have one image, let's add a second. Go to *File > Open and Place* and upload *puppy.jpg* into your file. Resize and place the puppy image within the canvas as you did with the floral design.



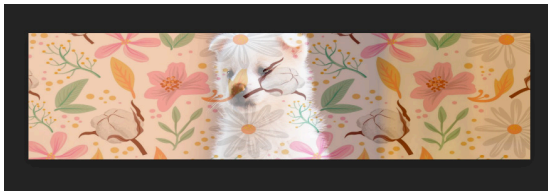
Feel free to add multiple images to your banner if you want to.

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Layers / Transparency



Part of creating a complicated visual composition with PhotoPea is using something called *Layers*. When you places images into PhotoPea you are automatically create a *layer*. Think of layers like pieces of paper stacked one stacked on top of one another. To view your document layers use the *Layers* panel at the lower right hand side of the application. If the layers panel has been closed you can reopen it by going to *Windows > Layers*.



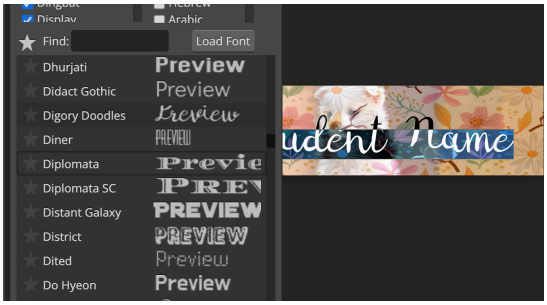
In my composition my puppy layer is stacked on top of my floral design layer. To create a blend between the two layers I will use the *Opacity* option in the *Layers* panel. Opacity is the measurement of how opaque or visible a layer is. To make our puppy layer semi-transparent set the opacity from 100% to 50%. If you have multiple layers feel free to affect the opacity for each layer.

Add Text



Finally, let's add some text to our banner. Begin by clicking on *T-icon* in the toolbar on the left hand side of the application, this is our text tool.

Click on the composition to add text. Once text has been added use the keyboard to set the text to your name.



Once you have typed your name use the *Text tool* to highlight it. You can use the text options in the upper left hand corner of the document to change / modify the typeface and the size of the text to make it larger or smaller.

Save your file as *banner.psd*. It is important to keep it as .psd file in order to maintain your separate layers.

Download & Submit



Great work! Download the banner as jpg file and name it *lastname-banner.jpg*.

Place *yourname-bird.jpg*, *yourname-crop.jpg* and *banner.jpg* into a folder with your name on it. Zip the folder and submit it to appropriate place on Canvas.

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